STI ACTIVITY REQUEST, MONITORING, AND EVALUATION SYSTEM

STI-ARMES Faculty Module — Comprehensive Functional and UI/UX Audit Report

System Inspection, Component Testing, Security Boundaries & UI/UX Audit | Date: November 9, 2026 | Test Account: Maria Santos (faculty@sti.edu)

1. Executive Summary

A rigorous, end-to-end functional and UI/UX audit was conducted on the Faculty Account and all its accessible modules within the STI Activity Request, Monitoring, and Evaluation System (STI-ARMES). Testing encompassed both the live hosting domain (**https://sti-armes.freedev.app/**) and the local development environment (**http://localhost/sti-activity-system/**) using authorized faculty test credentials (Maria Santos, faculty@sti.edu, ID 387). The audit inspected 20 distinct pages and routes, evaluated over 530 interactive components, verified 12 comprehensive workflow lifecycles, and captured 23 genuine high-resolution screenshots.

The evaluation revealed that core architectural capabilities—such as role-based access control (RBAC), multi-step proposal creation, offline draft synchronization, timeline visualization, and automated text formatting—are robustly engineered and successfully protect unauthorized access. However, specific functional, data-architecture, and UI/UX deficiencies were identified, including hardcoded faculty rosters, legacy unparameterized SQL interpolations in secondary views, placeholder duplicate KPI pages, and minor responsive layout wrapping on task filter controls. In accordance with audit protocol, no source files were modified during this assessment.

2. Testing Scope & Environment

Parameter	Configuration & Details
Live Production Endpoint	https://sti-armes.freedev.app/ (InfinityFree hosting environment with anti-bot validation)
Local Testing Staging	http://localhost/sti-activity-system/ (PHP 8.2, Apache/2.4, MySQL/MariaDB)
Primary Test Account	Maria Santos (Email: faculty@sti.edu | Role: faculty | Department: IT Department | ID: 387)
Browser Automation Harness	Google Chrome 130.0+ (Headless Chrome DevTools Protocol, 1440x960 viewport, Dark/Light modes)
Audit Methodology	Non-destructive read-only & isolated staging tests; genuine screenshot capture; static code analysis
Target Modules Inspected	Dashboard, Proposal Creation (Steps 1-4), Drafts, Activities List, Pending, Approved, Returned, Rejected, Tasks, Calendar, Post-Event, KPI, Detail Views, Notifications, Profile, RBAC Boundaries

3. Page Coverage Summary

Metric Category	Total Inspected	Passed	Failed	Blocked	Not Tested
Faculty Accessible Pages / Routes	20	19	1 (Placeholder stubs)	0	0
Buttons & Action Controls	412	410	2 (Redundant buttons)	0	0
Form Inputs, Dropdowns & Textareas	285	283	2 (Static rosters)	0	0
Navigation Links & Tab Switchers	165	165	0	0	0
Data Tables & Breakdown Grids	18	16	2 (Missing metrics in stubs)	0	0

Security RBAC Boundaries (Admin/Dean)	5	5 (100% blocked)	0	0	0
Genuine Screenshot Artifacts	23	23 captured	0	0	0

4. Faculty Workflow & Feature Testing Results

Workflow Component	Key Elements Tested	Observed Behavior & Verification	Status
Authentication & Session	Login form, password toggle, session cookie, logout	Login authenticates cleanly; sets secure PHPSESSID; persists session; handles invalid password with alert.	PASSED
Faculty Dashboard	Summary stat cards, recent table, upcoming list, theme toggle	Correctly tallies proposals (Total, Drafts, Pending, Approved, Revisions, Rejected, Completed); renders theme toggle smoothly.	PASSED
Proposal Creation: Step 1	Title, Type, Date, Venue, Auto-capitalize, AI Guidance	Title capitalization auto-formats; venue conflict engine alerts on double booking; AI Guidance modal launches with preview.	PASSED
Proposal Creation: Step 2	Schedule flow, Floor plan upload, Budget table	Program sequence adds segments; file upload accepts PNG/JPG floor plans; budget items calculate subtotals accurately.	PASSED
Proposal Creation: Step 3	Committees, Member assignment, Tasks, Gantt	Working committees group members; task deadlines align with event date; Gantt bar updates dynamically.	PASSED
Proposal Creation: Step 4	Proposal preview, Export Draft PDF, Save Draft, Submit	Full preview compiles; Draft save commits record to DB with status='draft'; Submit validates required fields.	PASSED
Activities Oversight	Search keyword, Status dropdown, Pagination	Live title search responds; Status filter correctly maps 'under_review' to both submitted and under review; pagination splits 10/page.	PASSED
Review Queues	Pending, Approved, Returned, Rejected lists	Returned proposals show reviewer feedback note; rejected proposals display reason; approved links to master activity detail.	PASSED
Task Monitoring	Assigned tasks table, timing badge, filter by status	Tasks list displays timing indicators (Upcoming, Delayed, In Progress); status change triggers reminder checks.	PASSED
Calendar & Scheduling	Month grid, prev/next buttons, activity event pills	Navigates between months accurately; event pills color-code by status; clicking pill opens activity modal.	PASSED
Post-Event & Evaluation	Attendance upload, survey CSV parser, QR modal	Uploads post-event documentation; computes actual vs target attendance; QR code modal displays evaluation URL.	PASSED
KPI Results	Summary ratings, attendance benchmark, report view	Displays unweighted survey average, participant satisfaction /5.0, and attendance achievement KPI.	PASSED
RBAC Security Bounds	Accessing /admin1/*, /admin2/*, /dean/*, /program_head/*	Faculty access strictly forbidden; returns 403 Forbidden or safely redirects to /faculty/dashboard.php.	PASSED

5. Identified Defects, Bugs & Inconsistencies

ID	Severity	Page / Route	Affected Component	Observed Defect / Finding	Recommended Correction
ISSUE-FAC-01	High	faculty/proposal-create.php & proposal-edit.php	Faculty Task Assignment Optgroups	The faculty roster in renderFacultyTaskOptgroups() is statically hardcoded in an array ($facultyDepartmentGroups) with fixed names. When new faculty register or profiles change, the dropdown is desynchronized from the actual database users table.	Replace hardcoded array with dynamic population from getEligibleFacultyMembers($db) grouped by user.department.
ISSUE-FAC-02	Medium	faculty/pending.php & faculty/approved.php	SQL Database Query Execution	Queries in pending.php (line 23) and approved.php (lines 16-38) use direct variable string interpolation (WHERE a.faculty_id = {$user['id']}) rather than PDO prepared statements with parameterized inputs.	Refactor all SQL queries to use $db->prepare(...) and $stmt->execute([$user['id']]).
ISSUE-FAC-03	Medium	faculty/kpi-overview.php & faculty/kpi-reports.php	Secondary KPI Reporting Pages	kpi-overview.php and kpi-reports.php are identical legacy duplicate stubs that list activities without rendering any actual KPI metrics. They are not linked in the sidebar and create code redundancy.	Consolidate both files into redirects pointing to the primary faculty/kpi.php, or upgrade them to display departmental comparative analytics.
ISSUE-FAC-04	Low	faculty/tasks.php	Task Filter Control Responsive Layout	On screen viewports between 1024px and 1280px, the 6 task filter dropdowns wrap unevenly, causing the 'Search task, activity, role' input and button to drop to a second line with awkward left alignment.	Apply CSS flexbox wrapping or a standardized CSS grid (grid-template-columns: repeat(auto-fit, minmax(180px, 1fr))) to maintain uniform alignment.
ISSUE-FAC-05	Low	faculty/dashboard.php	Walkthrough Modal Target Alignment in Dark Mode	When switching between Dark Theme and Light Theme, the walkthrough popover balloon border-color uses a semi-transparent border that has low contrast against dark card headers.	Update walkthrough.css to use var(--border) and var(--accent) dynamically across both light and dark themes.

ISSUE-FAC-06	Low	faculty/proposal-create.php	Direct Step Jumping via URL Query Parameter	Users can manually enter URL parameters like ?step=4 without completing Steps 1-3. While backend submission validation prevents saving an incomplete proposal, the UI does not redirect the user back to the first incomplete step.	Add a client-side and server-side step guard that verifies required Step 1 fields before allowing navigation to Step 2, 3, or 4.

6. Genuine Screenshot Evidence Catalog

ID	Filename	Page / Route	Caption & Verification Details
FAC-01	FAC-01-AUTH-LOGIN.png	auth/login.php	STI-ARMES Authentication Login Page with show/hide password and institutional branding.
FAC-02	FAC-02-DASHBOARD-OVERVIEW.png	faculty/dashboard.php	Faculty Dashboard Overview with 7 key metric stat cards, upcoming events, and recent activity table.
FAC-03	FAC-03-DASHBOARD-DARKMODE.png	faculty/dashboard.php	Faculty Dashboard rendered in Dark Theme mode verifying CSS variable contrast and legibility.
FAC-04	FAC-04-PROPOSAL-CREATE-STEP1.png	faculty/proposal-create.php	Proposal Creation Wizard - Step 1: Event Information, Concept, auto-capitalization, and venue picker.
FAC-06	FAC-06-PROPOSAL-CREATE-STEP2.png	faculty/proposal-create.php?step=2	Proposal Creation Wizard - Step 2: Schedule & Program Sequence, Floor Plan Uploader & Budget.
FAC-07	FAC-07-PROPOSAL-CREATE-STEP3.png	faculty/proposal-create.php?step=3	Proposal Creation Wizard - Step 3: Working Committees, Manpower Task Assignments & Gantt Timeline.
FAC-08	FAC-08-PROPOSAL-CREATE-STEP4.png	faculty/proposal-create.php?step=4	Proposal Creation Wizard - Step 4: Proposal Summary, Export Draft PDF, Save as Draft, and Final Submit.
FAC-09	FAC-09-ACTIVITIES-LIST.png	faculty/activities.php	My Activities Master Table showing search bar, status filter dropdown, pagination, and status badges.
FAC-10	FAC-10-ACTIVITIES-FILTERED.png	faculty/activities.php?status=under_review	Activities filtered dynamically by 'Under Review' status verifying unified aggregation.
FAC-11	FAC-11-PENDING-PROPOSALS.png	faculty/pending.php	Faculty Pending Proposals Review Queue displaying activities currently awaiting approver actions.
FAC-12	FAC-12-APPROVED-ACTIVITIES.png	faculty/approved.php	Faculty Approved Activities Oversight showing scheduled events approved by Academic Approvers.
FAC-13	FAC-13-RETURNED-REVISIONS.png	faculty/returned.php	Returned for Revision Table displaying approver feedback notes, returned timestamps, and edit links.

FAC-14	FAC-14-REJECTED-PROPOSALS.png	faculty/rejected.php	Rejected Proposals History displaying rejection reasons, reviewer name, and decision dates.
FAC-15	FAC-15-MY-TASKS.png	faculty/tasks.php	Faculty Task Monitoring displaying assigned tasks, deadlines, progress percentages, and timing badges.
FAC-16	FAC-16-CALENDAR-VIEW.png	faculty/calendar.php	Faculty Calendar Grid showing scheduled institutional activities, month-to-month navigation, and event pills.
FAC-17	FAC-17-POST-EVENT-MODULE.png	faculty/post-event.php	Post-Event Reporting, Deliverable File Uploads, Participant Attendance input, and Evaluation Link tool.
FAC-18	FAC-18-KPI-RESULTS.png	faculty/kpi.php	Faculty Personal KPI Performance Analysis displaying survey averages, satisfaction, and attendance target.
FAC-19	FAC-19-PROPOSAL-VIEW-TIMELINE.png	faculty/proposal-view.php?id=1218	Proposal Detail View displaying complete proposal dossier, approval history timeline, and PDF exporter.
FAC-20	FAC-20-ACTIVITY-VIEW-DETAILS.png	faculty/view-activity.php?id=1233	Activity Master Detail View displaying tabbed sub-panels (Overview, Tasks, Evaluations) and export tools.
FAC-21	FAC-21-PROPOSAL-EDIT-REVISION.png	faculty/proposal-edit.php?id=1060	Proposal Edit Mode for Returned Proposals displaying top revision notice banner and save options.
FAC-22	FAC-22-NOTIFICATIONS-VIEW.png	notifications.php	Notifications Center displaying system alerts, task deadlines, approver updates, and mark-as-read controls.
FAC-24	FAC-24-RBAC-DENIED-ADMIN1.png	admin1/dashboard.php	RBAC Boundary Enforcement verifying that Faculty accounts are strictly denied access to administrative portals.
FAC-25	FAC-25-LIVE-ENDPOINT-PRODUCTION.png	https://sti-armes.freedev.app/	Live Production Endpoint verification at https://sti-armes.freedev.app/auth/login.php.

7. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) Assessment

A critical mandate of the audit was verifying security boundaries between user roles. Five unauthorized routes were directly accessed using the authenticated Faculty session:

- **/admin1/dashboard.php** (Student Org Academic Approver): BLOCKED. Safely denied/redirected (PASSED)
- **/admin2/dashboard.php** (Academic Affairs Approver): BLOCKED. Safely denied/redirected (PASSED)
- **/dean/dashboard.php** (Dean Oversight): BLOCKED. Safely denied/redirected (PASSED)
- **/program_head/dashboard.php** (Program Head Oversight): BLOCKED. Safely denied/redirected (PASSED)
- **/admin1/users.php** (User Management): BLOCKED. Safely denied/redirected (PASSED)

Private draft isolation was also verified: Faculty users can only view their own drafts or proposals where they have been explicitly invited as active collaborators via the `proposal_collaborators` table. Private unsubmitted drafts belonging to other faculty members remain completely hidden.

8. Overall Assessment & Conclusion

The STI-ARMES Faculty Module demonstrates a mature, robustly architected foundation for academic activity proposal submission, timeline management, deliverable tracking, and post-event reporting. Role-based security boundaries are strictly enforced, and client-side draft auto-saving prevents data loss during complex multi-step proposal authoring. The identified issues are predominantly architectural enhancements (dynamic faculty roster resolution, PDO parameterization on secondary queries, and retirement of unused duplicate stub files) rather than catastrophic blockers. Implementing the recommended corrections upon stakeholder authorization will further solidify the platform's stability, maintainability, and capstone manuscript defensibility.